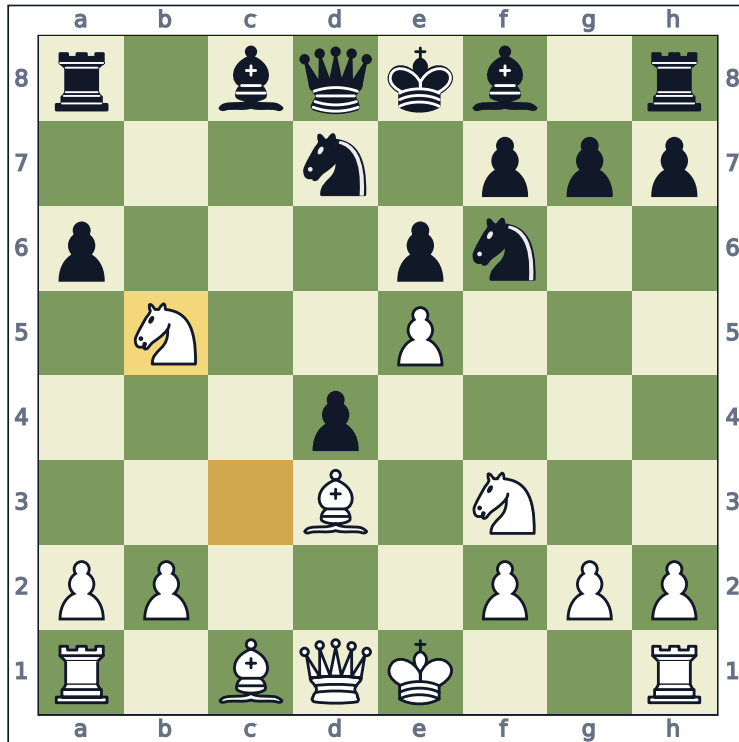


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Semi-Slav Defense

ECO D49 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.08 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D49 covers Semi-Slav Defense. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Blumenfeld Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d4, White pawn on e5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D49 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to D49 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Blumenfeld Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5

002 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Rabinovich Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5 Ng4

003 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Rellstab Attack

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5 Nxe5 12. Nxe5 axb5 13. O-O Qd5 14. Qe2 Ba6 15. Bg5

004 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Sozin Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5 Nxe5

005 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Sozin Variation

1. d4 d5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. c4 c6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5 Nxe5 12. Nxe5 axb5 13. O-O

006 Semi-Slav Defense: Meran Variation, Stahlberg Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Bd3 dxc4 7. Bxc4 b5 8. Bd3 a6 9. e4 c5 10. e5 cxd4 11. Nxb5 Nxe5 12. Nxe5 axb5 13. Qf3